

## Your Binding Constraint: **Retention**

Customers don't come back. You're running on a treadmill — constantly refilling the top of the funnel because customers leave out the bottom. Here's how to fix it.

### How This Shows Up

Repeat customer rate below 35%. Less than 20% on maintenance plans. Fewer than 10 reviews or rating below 4.0. 70%+ of marketing budget on new customer acquisition. Customers who used you once call a competitor next time.

### How It Plays Out by Industry

**HVAC:** Highest repeat potential — systems need service 2×/year. Plan members retain at 74-89% and have 2.3× higher lifetime value.

**Plumbing:** Event-driven demand — the retention play is being top-of-mind when the event happens (fridge magnets, seasonal postcards, Google dominance).

**Electrical:** Lowest repeat rate (29%) — the play is cross-selling: panel upgrade → EV charger → generator → surge protector.

### The Most Common Mistakes

1. No maintenance plan — the single highest-ROI move in the trades
2. No follow-up after the job — 52% of non-returns are communication failures
3. No review system — 42% of consumers won't use a business that never replies to reviews
4. Treating every customer as a one-time transaction
5. No seasonal touchpoints

## The Fix: Step by Step

**Step 1:** Launch a maintenance plan — annual tune-up + priority scheduling + 10% discount. \$150-250/year.

**Step 2:** Set up a review request system — text/email after every job with a direct Google review link.

**Step 3:** Build a seasonal touchpoint calendar — 4 touches/year per customer.

**Step 4:** Create a "we haven't seen you" campaign — email lapsed customers with a \$25 offer.

**Step 5:** Train techs to identify cross-sell opportunities.

## Do's and Don'ts

**Do:** Launch a maintenance plan — even a simple one. Ask every customer for a review. Send seasonal touchpoints 4×/year. Run a "we haven't seen you" campaign quarterly. Train techs to cross-sell.

**Don't:** Assume good work = repeat customers. Ignore reviews. Let customers go 12+ months without hearing from you.

### Want the full 6-Vector Roadmap?

This guide covers one constraint. A Growth Blocker Analysis covers all six — I pressure-test your scores against 400+ service business benchmarks and give you a complete growth roadmap in 30 minutes.

[Book a Growth Blocker Analysis →](#)